

Beat Development

Alexa Gagosz
The Boston Globe

Covering a hospital merger

Lifespan, Care New England sign definitive agreement to create integrated health system with Brown University

While observers note that the deal would increase access to care for many consumers, critics say that the merger could lead to less competition, job cuts, and a possible overall increase in health care costs.

Brown University's \$90k report on the Lifespan-Care New England merger offers a positive outlook but unclear data

Here's what a newly merged system between Lifespan and Care New England would look like, executives say

- Explainers help break down the script (for you and for the reader).
- Follow the moves, but then challenge and scrutinize them.
- Understand the process to inform the reader what happens next.

R.I. attorney general denies Lifespan-Care New England health care merger

“The parties have nothing more than a ‘plan to make a plan’ with respect to achieving the claimed benefits of combining, without accounting for the cost of achieving these benefits,” the

By [Alexa Gagosz](#) Globe Staff,
Updated February 17, 2022, 8:59 p.m.

Outgoing Care New England CEO reflects on merger attempts and the future of health care in R.I.

“Pandemic. Health care financing mess. We had a cyber attack in the middle of it all,” said Dr. James E. Fanale. “Who knew the last couple of years were going to happen?”

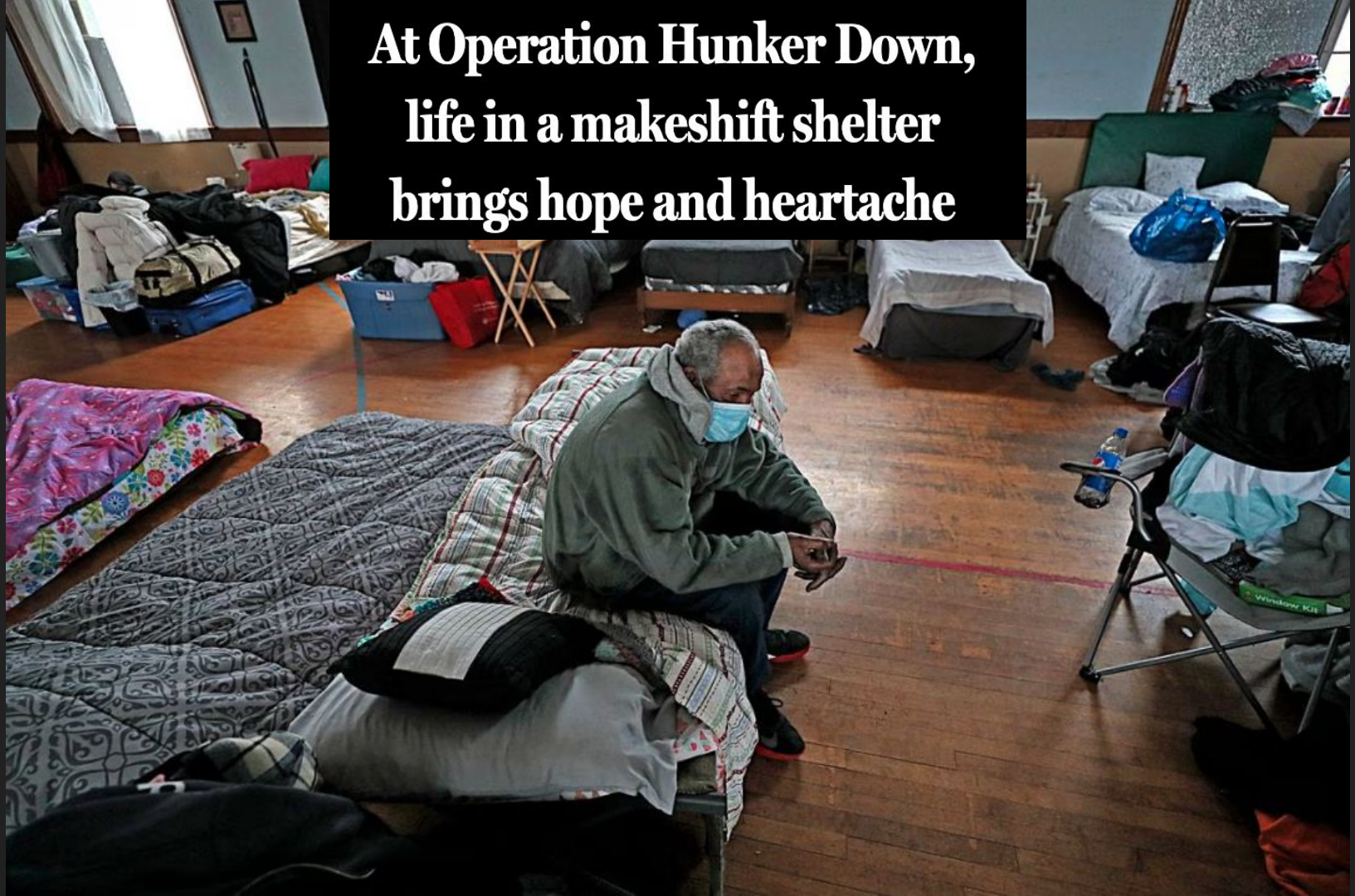
'I never realized what people go through': Doctor and former hospital CEO with Stage 4 cancer calls for greater empathy in medicine

Dr. James E. Fanale's new book "Onward" offers a glimpse of what it's like to be a cancer patient as a geriatrician

By [Alexa Gageez](#) Globe Staff, Updated November 13, 2023, 3:58 p.m.



**At Operation Hunker Down,
life in a makeshift shelter
brings hope and heartache**



[Story
here.](#)



RHODE ISLAND

How a hard-working, middle-class family spiraled into homelessness

With two working parents, \$80,000 a year in income, four kids, and a stable home in Rhode Island, the Strong family was living the American dream. Then they were evicted. And the nightmare began.

WRITTEN BY ALEXA GAGOSZ, PHOTOGRAPHS BY SUZANNE KREITER

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After six months of living in motel rooms, and two weeks living in a tent in a campground, Kiel Strong and his family of six are now sharing one room in his cousin's house. He searched for a movie for his sick children to watch as they quarantined in their room.

R.I. housing secretary's report may not be compliant with state law

A spokesman for House Speaker K. Joseph Shekarchi told the Globe that the Speaker is “disappointed” and plans to meet with Housing Secretary Joshua Saal to “better understand what prevented compliance.”

By **Alexa Gagosz** Globe Staff, Updated January 9, 2023, 9:53 p.m.



PROVIDENCE — The [integrated housing report](#) Housing Secretary Joshua D. Saal submitted to the General Assembly on Jan. 5 does not seem to be compliant with the state law, House Speaker K. Joseph Shekachi said.



The report, which was submitted [nearly a week after the D](#)
[2022 deadline](#), had errors and was missing key data points
required recommendations.

RI HOUSING

R.I. Housing Secretary Joshua Saal resigns

According to members of the Governor's office, McKee has had concerns about “several issues,” including a lack of communication and incomplete reports submitted by Saal to the General Assembly.

By **Alexa Gagosz** Globe Staff, Updated January 11, 2023, 1:09 p.m.





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FOOD & DINING

IN RHODE ISLAND

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Tips from my veteran reporter colleagues

On crime:

“If you cover cover cops, go for ride-alongs – not for stories – but just to get to know their job.” – Amanda Milkovits

On city politics:

“I went to City Hall every day when I started on the Providence beat. Now I don’t have to go as often because I know everyone, and my sources call ME instead of the other way around. But it took time to build that up.” - Steph Machado

Tips from my veteran reporter colleagues

In general:

- Read your outlet. Read the local paper. Listen to the bad talk radio. Consume everything you can.
- Make people see you out and about.
- Find out where people go to lunch or breakfast to talk about the job. **Hang out at the lunch counter.**
- Don't be afraid to ask the dumb questions or even do "dumb things."
- Never stop experimenting. There's nothing worse than getting in a routine when it comes to your own writing.